



Let's Talk!

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October 18, 2004 could have been just another day for Indians—hot, humid, and dehydrating. But, three events took place that day, and each had the potential to turn history around.

The rains at Chennai exposed the pathetic water draining systems at Indian stadia, and denied India a much-needed victory against Australia in the second Test of the Border-Gavaskar trophy. Later in the day, murderer, smuggler, kidnapper, and national nuisance Veerappan was shot dead in the Satyamangalam forests on the Karnataka-Tamil Nadu border.

But perhaps the most important news event of the day almost went unnoticed. For the first time in history, the number of mobile phones exceeded the number of landlines in the country. While cellular subscribers crossed the 44 million mark, fixed lines were at 43.82 million.

It is as much an evidence of India's fast growth to becoming a telecommunications giant, as much as the fact that the cellular phone growth has been led by a fundamental need of any growing economy—cheap, effective communication that is accessible to every person.

It is only natural, then, that Digit, India's most trusted source on personal technology, would publish the country's most exhaustive cellular phone buyers' guide for its readers.

Twenty-one pages of all the information you would ever want about buying cell phones in India.

When the Digit team started compiling information for the products available in the market, we thought it would be as easy as apple pie. It was not. Company web sites were woefully inadequate, sales representatives and

dealers were not forthcoming (or worse, ignorant), and there was no single source of information on even the number of phone models currently available in the market.

We scoured shops, visited company web sites, called up company helplines, spoke to readers, and even traced long-lost friends, to source information on the 100-plus cellular phone models officially available in India. The result is the 21 pages you would read now.

Navigating through the Buyers' Guide is child's play. Neatly headlined, and divided into various categories like basic, mid-end, high-end and PDA phones, the Guide is not just a listing of tabulated data. We have also included value-added features like tips and tricks, a primer on mobile etiquette, questions you simply must ask the dealer before you buy a phone, etc.

We hope the Buyers'

Guide would be a useful reference document for both first-time buyers, as well as for those who want to upgrade.

It would be a travesty if Digit publishes a one-time Cellphone Buyers' Guide. Digit will publish the Cellphone Buyers' Guide with as much regularity as new models keep coming in the market.

This is one document you just don't want to misplace, do you?

